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Health Insurance Policy

Individual, Family Floater & Senior Citizen Plans — India
Comprehensive Terms, Benefits, Waiting Periods, Exclusions and Claims Guide

- Hospitalisation
- Daycare
- Pre & Post
- Restoration
- AYUSH
- Mental Health

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CHAPTER 1 — INTRODUCTION TO ACKO HEALTH INSURANCE

1.1 The Health Insurance Imperative in India

India faces one of the world's most acute healthcare financing challenges. With medical inflation running at 14% annually — nearly double the general CPI inflation rate of 6–7% — the cost of quality healthcare in private hospitals has become prohibitive for the average Indian household. National Sample Survey (NSS) data consistently shows that over 47% of all hospitalisation expenses in India are paid out-of-pocket, pushing an estimated 55 million people into poverty each year due to catastrophic healthcare expenditure.

Representative healthcare costs in India's private hospital sector (2024 estimates):

Medical Condition / Procedure	Tier-1 Private Hospital	Tier-2 Private Hospital	Government Hospital
Cardiac bypass surgery (CABG)	INR 4,00,000 – INR 8,00,000	INR 2,50,000 – INR 4,00,000	INR 80,000 – INR 1,50,000
Angioplasty (single stent)	INR 2,50,000 – INR 5,00,000	INR 1,50,000 – INR 3,00,000	INR 60,000 – INR 1,20,000
Knee replacement (single knee)	INR 2,50,000 – INR 4,50,000	INR 1,50,000 – INR 2,50,000	INR 50,000 – INR 1,00,000
Liver transplant	INR 20,00,000 – INR 35,00,000	INR 15,00,000 – INR 25,00,000	INR 5,00,000 – INR 8,00,000
Cancer chemotherapy (per cycle)	INR 60,000 – INR 3,00,000	INR 30,000 – INR 1,50,000	INR 5,000 – INR 20,000
ICU stay (per day)	INR 15,000 – INR 50,000	INR 8,000 – INR 25,000	INR 2,000 – INR 5,000
Normal delivery	INR 60,000 – INR 1,20,000	INR 30,000 – INR 70,000	INR 5,000 – INR 15,000
Cataract surgery (per eye)	INR 35,000 – INR 80,000	INR 15,000 – INR 40,000	INR 5,000 – INR 15,000
Appendicitis (appendectomy)	INR 80,000 – INR 1,50,000	INR 40,000 – INR 80,000	INR 15,000 – INR 35,000
Kidney dialysis (per session)	INR 2,500 – INR 5,000	INR 1,500 – INR 3,000	INR 500 – INR 1,000

1.2 Acko Health Insurance — Key Advantages

- **Direct-to-Customer Model:** No agents, brokers, or intermediaries. Up to 25% premium savings passed to policyholders.
- **100% Digital:** Purchase, renewal, endorsements, claim registration, and pre-authorisation entirely via Acko app or website. No physical documents.
- **10,000+ Network Hospitals:** Cashless treatment at empanelled hospitals across all Indian states and union territories — from major metros to tier-2 and tier-3 cities.
- **Transparent Waiting Periods:** All waiting periods disclosed upfront at proposal stage. No hidden exclusions.
- **Mental Health Coverage:** Full IRDAI-compliant mental health coverage including hospitalisation for psychiatric conditions — not just physical illness.
- **AYUSH Coverage:** In-patient Ayurveda, Yoga, Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, and Homeopathy treatment at government-recognised facilities.

- **Restoration Benefit:** Sum Insured automatically restored after exhaustion — protecting the family from sequential illnesses in the same year.
- **Lifelong Renewability:** Coverage for life. Acko cannot deny renewal based on claims history.

CHAPTER 2 — DEFINITIONS AND INTERPRETATION

Insured Person	Individual(s) named in the Policy Schedule for whom health insurance coverage is provided under this policy.
Sum Insured	Maximum amount payable by Acko under this policy in a single policy year for all covered medical expenses combined. In a Family Floater, this is the shared pool for all covered family members.
Hospitalisation	Admission to a licensed Hospital as an In-Patient for a minimum continuous period of 24 hours for medically necessary treatment of a covered Illness or Injury. Daycare procedures requiring less than 24 hours are covered separately.
Hospital	Institution established for in-patient medical care meeting all of: minimum 10 in-patient beds; qualified medical staff and nurses on 24-hour duty; a fully equipped operation theatre; full diagnostic facility; registration with State Medical Authority.
Network Hospital	Hospital empanelled by Acko for cashless claim settlement. At Network Hospitals, the hospital bills Acko directly. List available at acko.com — updated monthly. 10,000+ hospitals nationwide.
Non-Network Hospital	Any hospital not on Acko's cashless network. Treatment here requires the Insured to pay bills and later claim reimbursement from Acko.
Daycare Procedure	Medical treatment or surgery requiring less than 24 hours hospitalisation due to technological advancement. Acko covers 541 listed daycare procedures across all specialties.
Pre-Existing Disease (PED)	Any illness, condition, disease, or injury (and related symptoms) for which: (a) the Insured Person had signs or symptoms within 48 months prior to first Acko policy date; or (b) any medical advice, diagnosis, care, or treatment was received within 48 months prior to first Acko policy date.
Waiting Period	Defined period from policy inception during which claims for certain specified illnesses or conditions are not payable, irrespective of when the condition was first diagnosed.
Initial Waiting Period	Mandatory 30-day waiting period from inception for all illnesses. Accidental injuries covered from Day 1. Life-threatening medical emergencies may be considered case-by-case.
Co-Payment	Fixed percentage of each admissible claim borne by the Insured Person. Example: 10% co-payment on INR 1,00,000 claim = Insured pays INR 10,000, Acko pays INR 90,000.
Deductible	Fixed amount of medical expenses the Insured must bear before Acko's coverage is triggered. Used in Super Top-Up plans. E.g., INR 3 lakh deductible means Acko pays only after total expenses exceed INR 3 lakhs in the year.
Room Rent Limit	Maximum daily hospital room accommodation charge (including nursing) covered by Acko. If actual room cost exceeds the limit, all associated charges are proportionately reduced in the same ratio.
Sub-Limit	Maximum amount payable for a specific treatment or benefit category within the overall Sum Insured. E.g., maternity sub-limit of INR 50,000 within a INR 10 lakh Sum Insured.

Restoration Benefit	Automatic reinstatement of 100% of the Sum Insured when it is exhausted during the policy year, for use towards a different illness. Available once per year (Health Plus) or unlimited times (Platinum).
Cumulative Bonus	Increase in Sum Insured at renewal for each claim-free year, at no extra premium. 5–10% per year up to 50–100% of base Sum Insured depending on plan.
Pre-Authorisation	Written or electronic approval from Acko before cashless hospitalisation. Mandatory for planned admissions (48 hours prior); must be obtained within 24 hours for emergency admissions.
TPA	Third Party Administrator. IRDAI-licensed entity that processes health insurance claims on behalf of Acko including pre-authorisation and reimbursement processing.
AYUSH	Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Homeopathy — Indian traditional medicine systems. Covered for in-patient treatment at government-recognised AYUSH hospitals.
Portability	Right of policyholder to transfer health policy from one IRDAI insurer to another at renewal, preserving accumulated waiting period credits.
Free Look Period	15-day period (30 days for distance marketing) from policy receipt for the policyholder to review and return the policy if not satisfied. Full refund minus proportionate premium and stamp duty.
Lifelong Renewability	Policy is renewable for the insured's lifetime. Acko cannot refuse renewal solely due to claims made. Premium may change at renewal based on age band or IRDAI-approved product revision.
Grace Period	30-day period after policy expiry for paying renewal premium. No coverage during grace period. Waiting period credits preserved if renewed within grace period.

CHAPTER 3 — HEALTH INSURANCE PLANS — COMPLETE GUIDE

3.1 Acko Health Basic Plan

Entry-level plan for young, healthy first-time buyers seeking essential hospitalisation coverage at affordable premiums.

Sum Insured	INR 3 Lakh / INR 5 Lakh / INR 7 Lakh
Entry Age	18 to 65 years (adults); 3 months to 17 years (children — with parent)
Room Type	Single private AC room — room rent limit applies (see policy schedule)
Pre-Hospitalisation	30 days before admission
Post-Hospitalisation	60 days after discharge
Daycare Procedures	541 listed procedures covered
Ambulance	INR 3,000 per hospitalisation
AYUSH Treatment	Not available in Basic Plan
Mental Health Cover	Not available in Basic Plan
Restoration Benefit	Not available — one-time Sum Insured only
Annual Health Check-up	INR 1,000 per insured person
Co-Payment	Nil (below 60 years); 20% co-pay for age 60 and above
PED Waiting Period	36 months
Cumulative Bonus	Nil
Premium (indicative)	INR 4,500 – INR 14,000 per year depending on age and sum insured

3.2 Acko Health Plus Plan

Mid-tier plan for individuals, couples, and families wanting restoration benefit, AYUSH coverage, and cumulative bonus on top of core hospitalisation.

Sum Insured	INR 5 Lakh / INR 10 Lakh / INR 15 Lakh
Pre-Hospitalisation	60 days before admission
Post-Hospitalisation	90 days after discharge
Daycare Procedures	541 listed procedures covered
Ambulance	INR 5,000 per hospitalisation
AYUSH Treatment	In-patient only — up to 25% of Sum Insured
Mental Health Cover	Full coverage per IRDAI 2023 guidelines
Restoration Benefit	100% of Sum Insured — once per policy year for different illness
Cumulative Bonus	5% per claim-free year — up to 50% of base Sum Insured
Annual Health Check-up	INR 1,500 per insured person

Co-Payment	Nil (below 60 years); 10% co-pay for age 60 and above
PED Waiting Period	36 months
Maternity Cover	Not included standard — add-on available with 24-month wait
Premium (indicative)	INR 7,500 – INR 28,000 per year depending on age, plan, and family size

3.3 Acko Platinum Health Plan

Premium plan with zero co-payment, unlimited restoration, shortest PED waiting period, optional maternity, and no room rent sub-limits.

Sum Insured	INR 10 Lakh / INR 25 Lakh / INR 50 Lakh / INR 1 Crore
Co-Payment	ZERO — Acko pays 100% of all admissible claims
Room Type	No restriction — any room category including deluxe and suite
Pre-Hospitalisation	60 days before admission
Post-Hospitalisation	90 days after discharge
PED Waiting Period	12 months (reduced from standard 36 months)
Restoration Benefit	Unlimited times per year — each activation for a different illness
AYUSH Treatment	Covered — up to 25% of Sum Insured
Mental Health Cover	Full coverage — no sub-limit
Organ Donor Cover	Up to INR 2,00,000 for donor's hospitalisation costs
Maternity Cover (Add-on)	Normal + C-section delivery; newborn cover from Day 1 of birth; 24-month wait
Cumulative Bonus	10% per claim-free year — up to 100% of base Sum Insured
Annual Health Check-up	INR 2,000 per insured person — at any empanelled diagnostic centre
Premium (indicative)	INR 12,000 – INR 65,000 per year depending on age, sum insured, and family composition

3.4 Acko Senior Citizen Plan

Tailored for individuals aged 60 and above, with acceptance of pre-existing conditions from Year 1 subject to co-payment.

Entry Age	60 to 80 years at first entry; renewable for life
Sum Insured	INR 3 Lakh / INR 5 Lakh / INR 10 Lakh
Co-Payment	20% — Acko pays 80% of each admissible claim
PED Coverage	Covered from Year 1 (co-payment applicable on PED claims too)
Specific Disease Waiting Period	12 months (reduced from standard 24 months)
Cataract Surgery	Covered after 12-month wait
Annual Health Check-up	INR 2,500 per insured person — comprehensive geriatric panel
Medical Second Opinion	One free online second opinion per year for critical diagnosis

Premium (indicative)	INR 18,000 – INR 70,000 per year — varies significantly with age
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3.5 Acko Family Floater Plan

Single policy — shared Sum Insured — for the entire family. More cost-effective than individual policies for families with young members.

Sum Insured	INR 5 Lakh to INR 1 Crore (available across all plan variants)
Family Composition	Self + Spouse + up to 4 dependent children (3 months to 25 years)
Extended Family	Parents and in-laws added as separate insured persons at additional premium
Newborn Cover	Newborn covered from Day 1 if born during policy period (Platinum + maternity add-on)
Sum Insured Sharing	All family members share the total pool. One member's major illness can exhaust it.
Floater NCB / Bonus	Cumulative bonus applies to the floater Sum Insured as a whole
Premium Basis	Based on age of oldest covered member and total number of insured persons
When Floater Works Best	Young, healthy families where simultaneous major claims for multiple members are unlikely

3.6 Acko Super Top-Up Plan

Cost-effective way to enhance existing coverage. Activates only after total annual medical expenses exceed a chosen deductible. Ideal for those with employer/ESIC/base health policy.

Sum Insured (Top-Up Layer)	INR 10 Lakh / INR 20 Lakh / INR 30 Lakh / INR 50 Lakh
Deductible Options	INR 3 Lakh / INR 5 Lakh / INR 10 Lakh / INR 15 Lakh
How It Activates	Acko pays claims above the chosen deductible threshold in the policy year
Deductible Fulfilment	By base health policy, group insurance, or out-of-pocket payment
Per-Year Deductible	Deductible applies once to annual total — not per hospitalisation
Cost Advantage	60–70% cheaper premium than equivalent base Sum Insured — same coverage above deductible
Best Use Case	Supplement INR 3–5 lakh employer cover with a INR 20 lakh Super Top-Up at INR 3 lakh deductible

CHAPTER 4 — COVERAGE BENEFITS — COMPREHENSIVE GUIDE

4.1 In-Patient Hospitalisation (IPD)

The core benefit — all medically necessary expenses for hospitalisation as an in-patient for 24+ hours. Covered components:

Expense Category	Coverage Details	Notes
Room & Boarding	Up to Room Rent Limit per day	Exceeding limit reduces ALL associated charges proportionately
ICU / HDU Charges	Up to 2× Room Rent Limit per day	Applies when medically necessary
Surgeon's Fees	In full — no sub-limit on standard plans	Per IRDAI schedule — not provider tariff
Anaesthetist's Fees	In full	Standard rates apply
Specialist Consultation	In full during hospitalisation	Pre-authorised specialists
Operation Theatre Charges	In full including disposables	Standard OT rates apply
Medicines and Drugs	As prescribed for in-patient treatment	No OPD pharmacy bills
Diagnostic Tests	All clinically necessary tests during hospitalisation	Blood tests, imaging, pathology
Blood and Blood Products	As required during treatment	Packed cells, platelets, plasma, FFP
Physiotherapy (In-Patient)	As part of in-patient treatment plan	Post-surgery physio during admission
Medical Devices and Implants	As per IRDAI Implant Price Schedule	Stents, pacemakers, prosthetics
Hospital Nursing Charges	Included in room rate or billed separately	Both covered up to Room Rent Limit

4.2 Pre-Hospitalisation Expenses — 60 Days

Medical expenses incurred for the SAME illness or injury for which subsequent hospitalisation occurs, up to 60 days before the admission date. Includes:

- Doctor consultations and specialist referrals leading to the diagnosis.
- Diagnostic investigations: blood tests (CBC, LFT, KFT, HbA1c, lipid profile, thyroid, etc.), X-rays, CT scans, MRI, PET scans, ultrasounds, ECG, Echo.
- Prescribed medicines and drugs taken as part of the pre-hospitalisation treatment.
- Biopsy, FNAC, or other tissue sampling procedures if performed before admission.
- All pre-hospitalisation expenses must be for the SAME diagnosis as the hospitalisation.
- Submit pre-hospitalisation bills within 15 days of the post-hospitalisation claim window closing.

4.3 Post-Hospitalisation Expenses — 90 Days

Follow-up treatment expenses for the SAME illness after discharge, up to 90 days from discharge date. Includes:

- Follow-up consultations with the treating surgeon or specialist.
- Prescribed medicines, supplements, and drugs required during recovery.
- Diagnostic tests ordered by the physician to monitor recovery (e.g., INR monitoring post-cardiac surgery, HbA1c post-diabetic surgery).
- Physiotherapy sessions prescribed as part of post-discharge recovery programme.
- Wound dressing, suture removal, staple removal at clinic or OPD level.
- Claims must relate to the SAME diagnosis. Unrelated OPD consultations are excluded.

4.4 Daycare Procedures — 541 Listed

Technological advances have enabled many surgeries to be completed in under 24 hours. Representative covered procedures by specialty:

Specialty	Examples of Covered Daycare Procedures
Ophthalmology	Cataract surgery (with IOL implant), LASIK, glaucoma laser, retinal photocoagulation, pterygium excision
Oncology	All chemotherapy infusion sessions, radiation therapy, bone marrow biopsy, targeted therapy infusions
Nephrology	All haemodialysis sessions, peritoneal dialysis, kidney biopsy
Urology	Lithotripsy (ESWL) for kidney stones, ureteroscopy, cystoscopy, circumcision, vasectomy
Orthopaedics	Carpal tunnel release, trigger finger, knee aspiration, ganglion excision, tendon repair
General Surgery	Laparoscopic hernia repair, appendicectomy, cholecystectomy, varicose vein stripping
Gastroenterology	Colonoscopy with biopsy, gastroscopy, variceal banding, PEG tube insertion
ENT	Tonsillectomy, adenoidectomy, ear drum repair (myringoplasty), nasal polyp removal
Cardiology	Cardiac catheterisation (diagnostic), tilt table test, cardioversion
Gynaecology	D&C, hysteroscopy, laparoscopic procedures, colposcopy, LEEP
Neurology	Lumbar puncture, nerve conduction study (in some cases), botox for dystonia
Pulmonology	Bronchoscopy with biopsy, thoracentesis, pleural biopsy
Dermatology	Skin biopsy (if requiring minor surgery), mole removal (if medically indicated)

4.5 Ambulance Cover

Ambulance Type	Coverage	Limit
Ground Emergency Ambulance	Transportation from incident to nearest suitable hospital	Up to INR 5,000 per hospitalisation
Inter-Hospital Transfer	Transfer from inadequately equipped hospital to better facility	Up to INR 5,000 per transfer
Air Ambulance	Select Platinum plan variants only — for critical cases	As per Platinum plan schedule
Non-Emergency Transport	Not covered — must be genuine medical emergency	Excluded

4.6 AYUSH Treatment

India's traditional medical systems are covered for in-patient treatment at government-recognised AYUSH hospitals:

- **Ayurveda:** Panchakarma treatments, Ayurvedic surgery (Shalya Tantra), admitted patient care at Kerala Government Ayurveda hospitals and NABH-accredited private Ayurvedic hospitals.
- **Yoga and Naturopathy:** Admitted patient wellness treatment at government-approved naturopathy hospitals. Minimum 3-day admission required.
- **Unani:** In-patient treatment under the Unani system at government-recognised or NABH-accredited Unani medical institutions.
- **Siddha:** In-patient Siddha treatment — particularly relevant for Tamil Nadu and Karnataka patients.
- **Homeopathy:** In-patient homeopathic treatment for eligible conditions at government-recognised homeopathic hospitals.

Coverage limit: 25% of Sum Insured per year. AYUSH treatment at home or at non-recognised practitioners is excluded. OPD AYUSH consultations are also excluded under the standard plan.

4.7 Mental Health Coverage — IRDAI 2023 Guidelines

Following the Mental Healthcare Act 2017 and IRDAI's mental health insurance circular (2023), Acko provides comprehensive coverage for in-patient psychiatric treatment. Covered conditions:

- Clinical depression: major depressive disorder (MDD), persistent depressive disorder (dysthymia), seasonal affective disorder requiring hospitalisation.
- Anxiety disorders: generalised anxiety disorder (GAD), panic disorder, obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD), post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) — when requiring in-patient care.
- Bipolar affective disorder (Bipolar I and Bipolar II) — hospitalisation for acute manic or depressive episodes.
- Schizophrenia and related psychotic disorders — acute episodes requiring in-patient stabilisation.
- Eating disorders: anorexia nervosa and bulimia nervosa when requiring medically supervised in-patient treatment.
- Substance use disorders: medically supervised detoxification and rehabilitation at licensed de-addiction centres.
- Autism spectrum disorders — in-patient treatment for associated physical health complications.

Mental health hospitalisation must be at a licensed psychiatric facility (minimum 10 psychiatric beds). OPD psychiatric consultations and outpatient psychotherapy are NOT covered under standard plans.

CHAPTER 5 — WAITING PERIODS — COMPLETE REFERENCE TABLE

Waiting periods are contractual conditions — not exclusions — that prevent coverage of specific conditions for a defined period from policy inception. They are designed to prevent adverse selection (purchasing insurance only when you know you need treatment).

Waiting Period	Duration	Conditions Subject to Wait	Exceptions (No Wait)
Initial / Cooling-Off	30 days from inception	All illnesses and medical conditions	Accidental injuries (Day 1); Life-threatening emergencies (Day 1)
Pre-Existing Disease (PED)	36 months (12 months — Platinum)	Any illness the insured had within 48 months before first policy date	Accidental injuries occurring after policy start date
Specific Disease / Procedure	24 months	Cataract; Hernia (all types); Joint replacement (knee, hip); Piles and fissures; Fistula; Haemorrhoids; Sinusitis; Tonsillitis / Adenoids; Benign prostatic hyperplasia (BPH); Prolapsed intervertebral disc; Nasal septum deviation; Gallstones / Cholecystitis	Emergency surgery for same condition if life-threatening — may be considered case by case
Maternity Cover	24 months from add-on inclusion	Normal delivery; C-section; Ectopic pregnancy; Miscarriage; Complications of pregnancy; Pre-natal and post-natal care	Emergency hospitalisation for pregnancy complications threatening the mother's life — covered from Day 1
Bariatric / Weight-Loss Surgery	36 months	Sleeve gastrectomy; Gastric bypass; Gastric banding; Lap band surgery	None — 36-month wait is absolute
Dental Hospitalisation	24 months	Dental surgery requiring in-patient hospitalisation	Accidental damage to natural teeth requiring emergency surgery — covered from Day 1
Psychiatric Conditions	30 days (initial waiting period only)	All diagnosed psychiatric conditions	Psychiatric emergencies (acute psychosis, suicidal crisis) requiring emergency admission — Day 1
Cancer Treatment	30 days (initial waiting period only)	Chemotherapy, radiation, surgery for cancer diagnosed after policy inception	Cancer diagnosed before policy → PED waiting period applies

Portability and Waiting Period Credits: When you port your existing health policy to Acko from another IRDAI-registered insurer, the waiting period duration you have already completed with your previous insurer is credited to Acko's waiting periods. For example: 2 years served with previous insurer towards a 3-year PED waiting period = only 1 more year required with Acko. Submit portability application to Acko minimum 45 days before current policy expires..

CHAPTER 6 — EXCLUSIONS — WHAT IS NOT COVERED

The following conditions, treatments, and circumstances are specifically excluded from coverage under all Acko health insurance plans unless a specific add-on or endorsement has been purchased to remove the exclusion.

✗ 6.1 Cosmetic and Aesthetic Procedures

Any surgery or treatment primarily for cosmetic improvement or change in appearance: rhinoplasty; blepharoplasty; liposuction; breast augmentation (unless post-mastectomy); dermal fillers; botulinum toxin injections; laser hair removal; tattoo removal; dental veneers; teeth whitening; hair transplantation. Exception: Reconstructive plastic surgery that is a direct medical consequence of a covered accident or illness (e.g., post-mastectomy reconstruction, burn scar revision after a covered accident) is covered.

✗ 6.2 Intentional Self-Inflicted Injury

Treatment for any injury or medical condition that results from intentional self-harm, attempted suicide, or deliberate self-damage. Note: Pursuant to the Mental Healthcare Act 2017, hospitalisation required as part of a licensed psychiatric treatment programme following a suicide attempt is covered (mental health benefit applies). The exclusion applies to the physical injuries caused — not the underlying psychiatric condition.

✗ 6.3 War, Military Conflict, and Related Perils

Hospitalisation or treatment directly or indirectly caused by war (declared or undeclared), invasion by foreign forces, civil war, hostilities, rebellion, insurrection, military operations, or nuclear, chemical, or biological warfare. No add-on removes this exclusion.

✗ 6.4 Alcohol, Drug, and Substance Abuse

Treatment for any illness, injury, or medical condition primarily arising from or directly caused by: (a) voluntary chronic alcohol abuse — liver cirrhosis, pancreatitis, alcohol-induced cardiomyopathy due to alcoholism; (b) narcotic drug abuse or addiction; (c) substance abuse of any controlled psychotropic substance; (d) overdose of recreational substances. Note: Medically supervised psychiatric de-addiction treatment at a licensed facility IS covered under the mental health benefit.

✗ 6.5 Dental, Oral, and Ophthalmic (Routine)

Routine dental treatment: tooth extraction, root canal treatment, crowns, bridges, braces, orthodontic treatment, dental implants, dentures, veneers. Routine ophthalmic expenses: spectacles, contact lenses, refractive eye surgeries (LASIK) on standard plans. Note: Cataract surgery is covered after the applicable specific disease waiting period. Accidental damage to natural teeth requiring emergency in-patient surgery is covered from Day 1.

✗ 6.6 Infertility, Sub-fertility, and Assisted Reproduction

Investigation and treatment of infertility: semen analysis and sperm banking; ovarian stimulation and egg freezing; in-vitro fertilisation (IVF) including ICSI; intrauterine insemination (IUI); gamete intrafallopian transfer (GIFT); surrogacy expenses; hormone treatments for fertility. Note: Gynaecological conditions that ARE covered include PCOS (when requiring hospitalisation), endometriosis (when requiring surgery), and complications of early pregnancy.

✗ 6.7 Obesity, Weight Management, and Bariatric Surgery (Standard Plan)

Treatment for obesity including dietary counselling, weight management programmes, and bariatric surgery (sleeve gastrectomy, gastric bypass, adjustable gastric banding, laparoscopic bariatric surgery) is excluded under standard plans. Available as an add-on after 36-month waiting period. With the add-on, bariatric surgery requires: BMI $\geq$ 35 with at least one obesity-related co-morbidity (type 2 diabetes, hypertension, OSA); multidisciplinary team certification; documented failure of non-surgical weight management.

✗ 6.8 Experimental and Unproven Treatments

Any treatment, procedure, drug, or medical device that: has not received CDSCO (Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation) approval; is not considered standard medical practice in India by the Medical Council of India; is in clinical trial phase; is considered investigational by the treating institution. Includes: gene therapy for non-approved conditions; unapproved stem cell therapy; experimental cancer protocols; unregistered homoeopathic practitioners.

✗ 6.9 Unregistered Medical Practitioners and Facilities

Treatment by any person who is not a qualified, registered Medical Practitioner under the Medical Council of India Act; treatment at facilities not meeting the minimum Hospital criteria defined in Chapter 2; treatment by practitioners of unrecognised medical systems; treatment at facilities with fewer than 10 inpatient beds.

✗ 6.10 External Assistive Devices (Standard Plan)

Hearing aids of all types; all forms of corrective spectacles and contact lenses (except immediately post cataract surgery as prescribed); external orthopaedic devices not medically necessitated by a covered hospitalisation (standard prosthetics used after amputations from covered accidents are covered); home medical equipment including hospital beds, wheelchairs (for rental after discharge), oxygen concentrators for home use.

✗ 6.11 Maternity and Reproductive Health (Without Add-on)

All pregnancy-related expenses without the Maternity Add-on: antenatal consultations; prenatal tests; delivery (normal or C-section); miscarriage; medical termination of pregnancy; postnatal care; newborn baby's care expenses. With the Maternity Add-on and after the 24-month waiting period, these are covered subject to the sub-limits in the Policy Schedule.

✗ 6.12 HIV, AIDS and Sexually Transmitted Infections

Hospitalisation treatment primarily for HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus), AIDS (Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome), or AIDS-related complex is excluded under standard plans. Note: IRDAI has been progressively mandating HIV coverage — check the current policy schedule for applicable coverage updates. Sexually transmitted infections requiring hospitalisation (gonorrhoea, syphilis, chlamydia complications) are excluded.

CHAPTER 7 — HEALTH INSURANCE CLAIMS PROCESS

7.1 Types of Health Insurance Claims

Claim Type	Process	Best For	Processing Time
Planned Cashless	Pre-auth 48 hours before; hospital bills Acko	Scheduled surgery, planned treatment	2–6 hrs pre-auth; settlement post-discharge
Emergency Cashless	Admit first; pre-auth within 24 hours	Accidents, emergencies	24-hour pre-auth window
Reimbursement — Network	Paid by insured; claim submitted after discharge	When cashless not available	7–15 working days
Reimbursement — Non-Network	Any hospital; pay then claim	Treatment outside Acko network	10–20 working days
Pre-Hospitalisation Bills	Separate claim for 60 days pre-admission expenses	Diagnostic workup before surgery	7–10 working days
Post-Hospitalisation Bills	Separate claim for 90 days post-discharge expenses	Follow-up medicines and tests	7–10 working days

7.2 Planned Cashless Hospitalisation — Step by Step

1. Use Acko app → Health → Find Network Hospital. Search by city, locality, specialty, or hospital name. Over 10,000 hospitals nationwide.
2. Call the hospital's insurance or TPA desk at least 48 hours before planned surgery / 24 hours before planned medical admission.
3. The hospital's insurance desk raises a pre-authorisation request to Acko with: admission details, diagnosis, proposed treatment plan, and estimated cost.
4. Acko reviews the request and responds within 2–6 hours with: full approval; partial approval (with covered amounts); or query (requesting additional clinical information).
5. On approval, hospital proceeds with planned admission. Present your Acko Digital Health Card (available on Acko app) at the insurance desk.
6. During hospitalisation: if treatment scope changes (additional surgery needed, ICU admission required), hospital submits an enhancement request. Acko responds within 2 hours.
7. At discharge: hospital presents the final bill to Acko. Acko settles the admissible amount directly with the hospital. Insured pays only: co-payment (if applicable); room upgrade charges; personal comfort items; non-covered expenses.
8. Acko issues a Claim Settlement Advice (CSA) detailing: amount approved; deductions with reasons; amount paid to hospital; and any amount payable by insured.

7.3 Emergency Cashless Hospitalisation

- Rush the Insured Person to the nearest Acko Network Hospital. Use Acko app's Emergency mode to locate the closest empanelled hospital with emergency services.
- Inform the hospital's insurance/TPA desk about the Acko policy. They will initiate an emergency pre-authorisation request.
- If the nearest available hospital is non-network (in a genuine life-threatening emergency where network hospital is not accessible), admit there. Inform Acko within 24 hours of admission.
- Emergency pre-authorisation must be submitted within 24 hours of admission — by the hospital or by the family member via Acko app.
- Acko processes emergency pre-authorisations on a priority basis — typically within 2 hours of submission.

7.4 Documents Required for Health Claims

Document	Cashless	Reimbursement — Network	Reimbursement — Non-Network
Original Discharge Summary	Hospital submits to Acko	Upload via Acko app	Upload via Acko app
Original Hospital Bills and Receipts	Hospital submits to Acko	Submit originals to Acko	Submit originals to Acko
Claim Form (via Acko app)	Digital submission	Digital submission	Digital submission
Doctor's Prescription for Medicines	Hospital provides	Required for pre/post-hosp claims	Required for pre/post-hosp claims
Diagnostic Test Reports with Requisition	Hospital provides	Upload all reports	Upload all reports
Cancelled Cheque / NEFT Details	Not required	Required	Required
KYC Documents (Aadhaar/PAN)	On file with Acko	Required if first claim	Required if first claim
FIR / Medico-Legal Certificate	If accident — hospital provides	If accident — submit copy	If accident — submit copy
Previous Policy (portability)	Only for PED waiver claims	Only for PED waiver claims	Only for PED waiver claims

7.5 Health Claims Settlement Timeline

Claim Type	Target Timeline	Notes
Cashless Pre-Authorisation	2–6 hours (planned); 2 hours (emergency)	Hospital submits; Acko approves digitally
Enhancement Request During Admission	Within 2 hours	Hospital submits when scope changes
Final Bill Settlement (Cashless)	Within 7 working days of discharge	Hospital submits final bill post-discharge
Reimbursement — Complete Documents	Within 15 working days	From date of last document receipt
Pre-Hospitalisation Reimbursement	7–10 working days	Submit with or after main hospitalisation claim
Post-Hospitalisation Reimbursement	7–10 working days	Submit within 15 days after 90-day window closes
Grievance on Rejected Claim	15 working days for formal response	From date of written representation received
IRDAI IGMS Escalation	15 working days for Acko response	IRDAI monitors compliance

CHAPTER 8 — RENEWABILITY, PORTABILITY AND FREE LOOK

8.1 Lifelong Renewability

Acko health insurance policies are guaranteed renewable for the lifetime of the Insured Person, subject to payment of premium. Key conditions:

- Acko CANNOT refuse to renew a health insurance policy solely on the grounds of claims made in preceding year(s).
- Acko CANNOT cancel a health policy mid-term except for: fraud; material misrepresentation in the proposal; non-payment of premium.
- Premium may change at renewal: (a) when the insured moves to a higher age band; (b) when IRDAI approves a product-level premium revision applicable to all policyholders.
- IRDAI expressly prohibits individual loading (increasing premium based on individual claim history) for health insurance.
- At renewal, the policy is renewed on the same terms unless the policyholder or Acko initiates an endorsed change.

8.2 Grace Period

30 days from the policy expiry date for payment of renewal premium. Critical terms:

- NO COVERAGE during the grace period — any hospitalisation during the 30-day grace period is not covered.
- All waiting period credits, cumulative bonus, and NCB are fully preserved if policy is renewed within the grace period.
- If the policy lapses beyond the grace period, all accumulated waiting period credits are forfeited — fresh policy treated as a new policy with full waiting periods.
- Renewal is available via Acko app or website at any time within the grace period.

8.3 Free Look Period

A review-and-return right available only for new policies (not applicable to renewals):

- 15 days from the date of receipt of the Policy Document (30 days for policies sold through distance marketing: online, email, telephone, without face-to-face interaction).
- During this period: review all terms, conditions, exclusions, sub-limits, room rent limits, and co-payment provisions.
- If not satisfied, return the policy and receive a full refund MINUS: proportionate premium for days of coverage already provided; stamp duty charges; cost of any medical examination conducted during underwriting.
- No claim should have been made during the free look period for a refund to be applicable.
- The free look right is exercised by written request via Acko app or email to Acko.

8.4 Health Insurance Portability — Complete Guide

Portability Feature	Details
Right to Port	All health policyholders have the right to transfer to Acko from any IRDAI-registered insurer at renewal. Acko cannot refuse portability except on underwriting grounds.
Waiting Period Credit	All PED and specific disease waiting periods completed with previous insurer are credited. Acko's waiting period obligation reduced accordingly.
Sum Insured Change	Can increase Sum Insured on porting. Incremental amount is subject to fresh waiting periods only.
Application Deadline	Submit portability application to Acko minimum 45 days before current policy expiry. Acko has 15 days to accept or reject (with written reasons).
Effective Date	Ported policy starts the day after current policy expires — zero gap in coverage.

Documents Required	Last 3 years' policy schedules; complete claim history; fresh Acko proposal form; recent medical reports if specifically requested by Acko.
Cumulative Bonus	Cumulative bonus earned with previous insurer is portable subject to Acko's plan structure and maximum limits.
NCB / Bonus Portability	Acko credits the equivalent cumulative bonus — up to the maximum allowed under Acko's plan.

CHAPTER 9 — GENERAL CONDITIONS AND LEGAL PROVISIONS

9.1 Utmost Good Faith

Health insurance is founded on utmost good faith. The Policyholder and all Insured Persons must truthfully disclose: all pre-existing and current medical conditions; current medications; recent hospitalisation or diagnostic investigations; family medical history (diabetes, cancer, heart disease, genetic conditions); lifestyle factors (smoking, tobacco, alcohol consumption, BMI). Non-disclosure or misrepresentation of material facts may void the policy from inception and all claim amounts paid may be recovered.

9.2 Subrogation

If Acko pays a health insurance claim that arises from the negligence or wrongful act of a third party (e.g., a road accident caused by a reckless driver, or medical negligence), Acko is subrogated to all the Insured's rights to recover from that third party. The Insured must cooperate and must not take any action that prejudices Acko's right of subrogation.

9.3 Contribution

If the Insured Person is covered under multiple health insurance policies (including group/employer insurance), Acko pays only its rateable proportion of the admissible claim. The Insured must disclose all active health policies at the time of claim and submit parallel claims to all insurers simultaneously.

9.4 Fraud

Any fraudulent claim, submission of forged documents, collusion between the Insured and any healthcare provider, or deliberate inflation of claim amounts renders: the specific claim immediately repudiated; the entire policy cancelled; all premiums forfeited; and Acko's right to pursue civil and criminal action under IPC 1860, Insurance Act 1938, and Prevention of Money Laundering Act 2002.

9.5 Grievance Redressal

Escalation path: (1) Acko app — Raise Complaint; (2) grievance@acko.com — respond in 15 working days; (3) Acko Grievance Redressal Officer (address in Policy Schedule); (4) IRDAI IGMS: igms.irda.gov.in (if unresolved within 15 days); (5) Insurance Ombudsman: cioins.co.in — free, independent resolution for claims up to INR 30 lakhs; (6) Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission or Civil Court.

9.6 Data Privacy

Acko processes health insurance data (sensitive personal data) strictly in accordance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (DPDPA) and the Information Technology Act 2000. Health data is processed only for: underwriting and risk assessment; claims processing and settlement; regulatory reporting to IRDAI. Health data is NOT shared with marketing partners, advertisers, or any entity beyond claims-processing partners (hospitals, TPA) and regulatory authorities.

9.7 Governing Law

This policy is governed by the laws of the Republic of India. Disputes are subject to the escalation mechanism in Clause 9.5. If unresolved through those channels, disputes shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of courts in Bengaluru, Karnataka, or the Consumer Forum in the Insured's jurisdiction.

9.8 Policy Interpretation

This policy document and the Policy Schedule together form the entire insurance contract. In the event of any inconsistency, the Policy Schedule prevails over this document. Words in singular include plural and vice versa; masculine includes feminine.

CHAPTER 10 — NETWORK HOSPITALS AND CASHLESS FACILITY

Acko maintains a cashless hospital network of 10,000+ hospitals across India. The network is continuously expanded and updated monthly. Always check the current list on the Acko app before planning hospitalisation.

State / Region	Key Cities Covered	Network Hospital Availability	Tier
Maharashtra	Mumbai, Pune, Nagpur, Nashik, Aurangabad	Dense network — 1,000+ hospitals	Tier 1 - A
Tamil Nadu	Chennai, Coimbatore, Madurai, Salem, Tiruchirappalli	Strong network — 800+ hospitals	Tier 1 - A
Karnataka	Bengaluru, Mysuru, Mangaluru, Hubli-Dharwad	Dense network — 700+ hospitals	Tier 1 - A
Delhi NCR	Delhi, Gurugram, Noida, Faridabad, Ghaziabad	Very dense — 900+ hospitals	Tier 1 - A
West Bengal	Kolkata, Howrah, Durgapur, Siliguri	Strong network — 600+ hospitals	Tier 1 - A
Gujarat	Ahmedabad, Surat, Vadodara, Rajkot	Good network — 600+ hospitals	Tier 1 - B
Rajasthan	Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Kota	Moderate — 400+ hospitals	Tier 2
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow, Agra, Varanasi, Kanpur, Noida	Good coverage — 700+ hospitals	Tier 1 - B
Andhra Pradesh / Telangana	Hyderabad, Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada	Good — 500+ hospitals	Tier 1 - B
Kerala	Kochi, Thiruvananthapuram, Kozhikode, Thrissur	Strong — 500+ hospitals	Tier 1 - B
Punjab / Haryana	Chandigarh, Ludhiana, Amritsar, Gurugram	Good — 400+ hospitals	Tier 2
Northeast India	Guwahati, Shillong, Imphal, Agartala	Limited — 100+ hospitals	Tier 3

10.1 NABH-Accredited Hospitals

The National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers (NABH) accredits hospitals that meet defined standards of quality and patient safety. NABH-accredited hospitals are given preference in the Acko network. Even if a NABH-accredited hospital is not on Acko's cashless list, reimbursement claims from NABH hospitals are processed with priority and higher acceptance rate.

10.2 Government Hospital Claims

Treatment at government hospitals (AIIMS, PGI, district hospitals, government medical colleges) is covered under Acko health insurance for reimbursement claims. Cashless facility may not be available at all government hospitals. Reimbursement claims from government hospitals are accepted based on the official fee schedule. Very low treatment costs at government hospitals mean most claims are fully admissible without sub-limit issues.

CHAPTER 11 — HEALTH INSURANCE CLAIMS CASE STUDIES

Illustrative examples of how Acko processes health insurance claims in practice. All figures are representative.

CASE STUDY: Cardiac Surgery — Cashless | Acko Health Plus | INR 10 Lakh Sum Insured

Policyholder	Male, Age 54, Acko Health Plus, INR 10 Lakh Sum Insured, Policy in 4th year
Incident	Chest pain. Diagnosed with 3-vessel CAD. Cardiologist recommends triple bypass (CABG).
Pre-Hospitalisation	60-day pre-hospitalisation: cardiologist consultations INR 8,000; ECG, Echo, angiography INR 32,000; blood tests INR 4,500. Total pre-hosp: INR 44,500.
Cashless Pre-Auth	Hospital submits pre-auth 48 hours before surgery. Acko approves within 4 hours. Approved amount: INR 5,50,000.
Actual Hospital Bill	Room (5 days × INR 3,500): INR 17,500. ICU (3 days × INR 15,000): INR 45,000. Surgery + OT: INR 3,20,000. Implants (grafts): INR 80,000. Medicines: INR 35,000. Cardiac monitoring: INR 28,000. Total: INR 5,25,500.
Room Rent Check	Policy Room Rent Limit: INR 3,500/day. Actual room: INR 3,500/day — exact limit. No proportionate reduction applied.
Co-Payment	Nil (below 60 years on Health Plus plan)
Acko Pays to Hospital	INR 5,25,500 (full admissible amount)
Pre-Hospitalisation Claim	INR 44,500 submitted separately. Approved in full — all related to same cardiac diagnosis.
Post-Hospitalisation	90 days: cardiologist follow-ups INR 6,000; medicines INR 18,000; blood tests INR 5,000. Claimed: INR 29,000. Approved: INR 29,000.
Total Acko Payout	INR 5,99,000 (hospital + pre + post). Remaining Sum Insured: INR 4,01,000.

CASE STUDY: Cancer Chemotherapy — Daycare Claims | Acko Platinum | INR 25 Lakh

Policyholder	Female, Age 42, Acko Platinum, INR 25 Lakh Sum Insured, Policy in 2nd year
Diagnosis	Breast cancer (Stage 2B). Surgery performed in Month 1 (mastectomy). Chemotherapy prescribed — 6 cycles over 18 weeks.
Mastectomy Claim	Hospitalisation 3 days. Total bill INR 2,10,000. Acko pays in full (no room rent limit on Platinum). INR 2,10,000 settled.
Chemotherapy — Daycare Claims	Each chemotherapy session: INR 35,000–INR 65,000 per cycle. 6 cycles = approximately INR 2,70,000 total. Each cycle is a daycare claim (less than 24 hours).
Daycare Processing	Each cycle registered as separate daycare claim on Acko app. Pre-auth obtained for each cycle. Cashless settlement at oncology day-care centre.
Restoration Benefit	After mastectomy + 4 chemo cycles, Sum Insured is partially used. Restoration not triggered yet — still INR 18 lakhs remaining.
Post-Chemo Follow-Up	Radiation therapy (15 sessions, daycare): INR 1,80,000. Acko pays in full.
Total Acko Payout	INR 6,60,000 across all claims. Remaining Sum Insured: INR 18,40,000.
Key Benefit	No room rent sub-limit; zero co-payment; all daycare chemo sessions fully covered — Platinum plan at its best.

CASE STUDY: PED Claim After Waiting Period | Family Floater | INR 10 Lakh | Diabetic Patient

Policyholder	Male, Age 48, Family Floater INR 10 Lakh, Policy enters 4th year — PED waiting period (36 months) completed in Month 36.
Pre-Existing Disease	Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus — disclosed at proposal stage.
Incident in Year 4	Diabetic foot complication — gangrenous toe requiring below-knee amputation. Admitted to network hospital.
PED Waiting Period	36 months completed — diabetes-related claims now fully covered from Month 37.
Hospital Bill	Surgery INR 1,20,000; ICU 2 days INR 28,000; room 5 days INR 15,000; medicines INR 18,000; prosthetics INR 35,000. Total: INR 2,16,000.
Room Rent Limit	Actual room INR 3,000/day. Policy Room Rent Limit: INR 3,000/day. Exact — no proportionate deduction.
Co-Payment	Nil (Family Floater Plus Plan, below 60 years).
Acko Pays	INR 2,16,000 in full. Remaining floater Sum Insured: INR 7,84,000 for rest of policy year.
Key Lesson	Disclosing PEDs at proposal is essential — hiding them risks claim repudiation even after the waiting period. Disclosed PEDs are fully covered after the waiting period is served.

CHAPTER 12 — REGULATORY AND LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Insurance Act, 1938 (amended 2015)

Primary legislation governing all insurance in India. Establishes IRDAI; defines insurable interest; requires disclosure at proposal; mandates claim settlement timelines (30 days for undisputed claims, 45 days for disputed after appointment of independent reviewer); prescribes solvency norms.

IRDAI Health Insurance Regulations, 2016 (amended 2019, 2022)

Core framework for health insurance products: mandates standardised policy terms; requires lifelong renewability; establishes portability rights; defines waiting period limits; mandates cashless settlement facility; requires IGMS grievance system compliance.

Mental Healthcare Act, 2017

Decriminalises attempted suicide; mandates that mental illness be treated on par with physical illness by all stakeholders including insurers. Subsequent IRDAI circular (2023) mandated health insurers to include mental health coverage in all health insurance products.

Consumer Protection Act, 2019

Insurance is a 'service'. Policyholders can approach Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions at district (up to INR 1 crore), state (INR 1–10 crore), or national (above INR 10 crore) levels. Online filing at edaakhil.nic.in.

Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017

Free, impartial dispute resolution for policyholders. 17 ombudsman offices across India (Ahmedabad, Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, Chandigarh, Chennai, Dehradun, Delhi, Guwahati, Hyderabad, Jaipur, Kochi, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai, Noida, Patna, Pune). Maximum award: INR 30 lakhs. Full list: www.cioins.co.in.

Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023

Governs collection and processing of personal and health data. Health data is 'sensitive personal data' requiring explicit consent for processing. Right to data correction and erasure subject to regulatory retention requirements. Acko's Privacy Policy at acko.com/privacy.

IRDAI Integrated Grievance Management System (IGMS)

Online portal at igms.irda.gov.in for policyholder complaints. Acko is required to respond within 15 working days. IRDAI monitors response rates and takes regulatory action for non-compliance. IRDAI consumer helpline: 155255 (toll-free).

Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY

Government health insurance scheme providing INR 5 lakh coverage per year to eligible economically weaker families. Acko's commercial health insurance supplements PM-JAY for those who need higher coverage or are not eligible for PM-JAY.

CHAPTER 13 — GLOSSARY OF HEALTH INSURANCE TERMS

AYUSH	Ayurveda, Yoga, Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Homeopathy — covered Indian traditional medical systems.
CABG	Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting. Cardiac surgery to bypass blocked coronary arteries.
CDSCO	Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation. Approves drugs and medical devices for use in India.
Co-Payment	Policyholder's share of each admissible claim (fixed %). Reduces premium.
Cumulative Bonus	Annual increase in Sum Insured for claim-free years at no extra premium.
Daycare	Medical procedure completed in less than 24 hours due to technological advancement. 541 listed procedures covered.
Deductible	Fixed amount policyholder bears before insurance coverage triggers (used in Super Top-Up plans).
DPDPA	Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023. Governs health and personal data handling by Acko.
Free Look Period	15-day window to review and return new health policy for full refund.
Grace Period	30 days after expiry for renewal. No coverage during grace period.
IGMS	Integrated Grievance Management System. IRDAI's online portal for policyholder complaints.
IPD	In-Patient Department. Hospitalisation for 24+ hours.
IRDAI	Insurance Regulatory & Development Authority of India. Regulates all Indian insurers.
MCI	Medical Council of India. Registers qualified medical practitioners.
NABH	National Accreditation Board for Hospitals. Accredits hospitals meeting quality standards.
Network Hospital	Acko-empanelled hospital offering cashless treatment. 10,000+ hospitals nationwide.
OPD	Out-Patient Department. Day consultations — NOT covered under standard health plans.
PED	Pre-Existing Disease. Any condition diagnosed/treated within 48 months before first policy date.
PM-JAY	Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana. Government health scheme — INR 5 lakh for eligible families.
Portability	Right to transfer health policy to another IRDAI insurer preserving waiting period credits.
Pre-Auth	Pre-Authorisation. Acko's written approval before cashless hospitalisation.
Restoration Benefit	100% Sum Insured restored after exhaustion — for a different illness. Once (Plus) or unlimited (Platinum).
Room Rent Limit	Maximum daily hospital room cost covered. Exceeding proportionately reduces ALL associated charges.
Sub-Limit	Maximum amount for a specific treatment category within overall Sum Insured.
Sum Insured	Maximum annual coverage. Shared pool in Family Floater.
TPA	Third Party Administrator. IRDAI-licensed entity processing health claims on Acko's behalf.
Top-Up / Super Top-Up	Additional coverage activating above a deductible threshold. Cost-effective way to enhance base cover.
Waiting Period	Defined period during which certain conditions are not covered under the health policy.

CHAPTER 14 — HEALTH INSURANCE PREMIUM REFERENCE GUIDE

Health insurance premiums vary by age, plan type, sum insured, number of insured, co-payment chosen, and city tier. The following are indicative premium ranges — actual premiums are calculated by Acko's underwriting engine.

14.1 Individual Health Insurance — Indicative Annual Premiums

Age	Basic — INR 5L	Plus — INR 10L	Platinum — INR 25L	Senior — INR 5L
18–25 years	INR 4,800	INR 8,200	INR 16,500	Not applicable
26–35 years	INR 6,200	INR 10,500	INR 21,000	Not applicable
36–45 years	INR 9,500	INR 16,000	INR 32,000	Not applicable
46–55 years	INR 14,000	INR 24,000	INR 48,000	Not applicable
56–60 years	INR 18,500	INR 31,000	INR 62,000	Not applicable
61–65 years	Not available	INR 38,000 (10% co-pay)	INR 75,000 (10% co-pay)	INR 22,000
66–70 years	Not available	INR 48,000	INR 95,000	INR 32,000
71–80 years	Not available	Not available	Not available	INR 48,000

All premiums are exclusive of GST (18%). Actual premiums will differ based on exact age, medical history, city, and add-ons selected. Premiums are illustrative only.

14.2 Family Floater — Indicative Annual Premiums

Family Composition	Sum Insured INR 5L	Sum Insured INR 10L	Sum Insured INR 25L
Self (35) + Spouse (32)	INR 12,000	INR 19,500	INR 38,000
Self (38) + Spouse (35) + 1 Child	INR 14,500	INR 23,000	INR 45,000
Self (40) + Spouse (37) + 2 Children	INR 16,500	INR 26,500	INR 52,000
Self (45) + Spouse (42) + 2 Children	INR 21,000	INR 34,000	INR 67,000
Self (50) + Spouse (47)	INR 28,000	INR 45,000	INR 88,000

14.3 Factors That Affect Health Insurance Premium

Factor	Effect on Premium	Notes
Age of Oldest Insured	Older = Higher premium	Steepest increase after 50 years
Pre-Existing Diseases Declared	Loading may apply on standard plans	Varies by condition severity
Sum Insured	Higher = Higher premium	But not linearly — there are economies of scale
Co-Payment Chosen	Higher co-pay = Lower premium	10% co-pay saves ~15–20% on premium
Smoker vs Non-Smoker	Smokers pay higher premium	Relevant for applications above 45 years
City Tier	Metro cities slightly higher	Due to higher hospital costs in metros
Floater vs Individual	Floater typically cheaper for family	But shared pool risk
Plan Variant	Basic < Plus < Platinum	More benefits = higher premium

GST	18% on entire premium	Including add-ons and riders
Cumulative Bonus	Does not increase premium	Free benefit for claim-free years

CHAPTER 15 — MATERNITY AND NEWBORN COVER — DETAILED GUIDE

Maternity cover is available as an optional add-on under the Acko Platinum Health Plan only. It is subject to a mandatory waiting period of 24 months from the date the add-on is first included in the policy.

Maternity Benefit	Coverage Details	Sub-Limit
Normal Vaginal Delivery	All hospitalisation expenses for normal delivery including room, nursing, doctor and midwife charges	As per Platinum plan schedule
Caesarean Section	All hospitalisation expenses for C-section including surgeon, OT, anaesthetist, room, nursing	As per Platinum plan schedule — higher sub-limit
Pre-Natal Care	Ante-natal check-ups, ultrasound scans, blood tests during pregnancy	Included in pre-hospitalisation benefit
Post-Natal Care	Post-delivery consultations, prescribed medicines after discharge	Included in post-hospitalisation benefit
Ectopic Pregnancy	Emergency treatment for ectopic pregnancy (fallopian tube pregnancy)	Covered from Day 1 — life threatening
Miscarriage / Spontaneous Abortion	Hospitalisation for medically managed or surgical management of miscarriage	After 24-month wait
Complications of Pregnancy	HELLP syndrome, placenta previa, pre-eclampsia requiring hospitalisation	Covered from Day 1 if life-threatening
Newborn Baby Cover	Newborn's hospitalisation expenses during mother's delivery admission	Included in maternity claim
Newborn NICU	Neonatal ICU charges for premature or sick newborn	Separate sub-limit — see Policy Schedule
Congenital Disease (Newborn)	Newborn diseases detected at birth requiring immediate treatment	Case-by-case basis — declare at renewal

CHAPTER 16 — DIGITAL HEALTH SERVICES AND VALUE-ADDED BENEFITS

16.1 Acko Digital Health Card

Every Acko Health Insurance policyholder receives a Digital Health Card accessible via the Acko app under My Policies → Health Card. The card displays: insured member name; policy number; sum insured; TPA name (if applicable); Acko emergency helpline. Present this card at the hospital insurance desk to initiate cashless hospitalisation. No physical card is required — the app-based digital card is legally accepted at all Acko network hospitals.

16.2 Annual Health Check-Up Benefit

Acko health insurance plans include an annual health check-up benefit for each insured person. The check-up can be availed at any of Acko's empanelled diagnostic centres (listed on the Acko app). The benefit amount is deducted from the policy's total health check-up allocation and is not deducted from the Sum Insured. Results from the annual check-up are private to the policyholder and are not used by Acko for renewal underwriting or premium revision.

16.3 Medical Second Opinion

Acko Platinum plan policyholders are entitled to one free online second medical opinion per year through Acko's empanelled specialist panel. This is particularly valuable for: cancer diagnoses; complex cardiac procedures; neurosurgical recommendations; rare conditions requiring specialist expertise. The second opinion is provided by an AIIMS, PGI, or equivalent specialist and is delivered digitally within 5–7 business days of submission.

16.4 Mental Health Helpline

Acko partners with a licensed mental health support provider to offer policyholders access to trained counsellors for non-clinical support conversations. This is distinct from insurance coverage for psychiatric hospitalisation. The helpline is a wellbeing benefit — not a claim. Available to all insured persons on Health Plus and Platinum plans.

16.5 Track Claims on Acko App

Real-time claim tracking is available on the Acko app: My Claims → Select Active Claim. Track: registration confirmation; pre-auth status; survey appointment; repair/treatment progress; settlement amount; payment confirmation. Email and WhatsApp notifications at each milestone. Claim Reference Number (CRN) issued at registration for all tracking.

CHAPTER 17 — STATE-WISE HEALTH INSURANCE INSIGHTS

State	Disease Burden	Common Claims	Key Considerations
Maharashtra	High cardiovascular disease, diabetes	Cardiac surgery, dialysis, diabetes management	High hospital costs in Mumbai — choose adequate Sum Insured
Tamil Nadu	High hypertension, renal disease, dengue	Dialysis, dengue treatment, cardiac	AYUSH (Siddha) well-established — claim those expenses
Kerala	High cancer incidence, cardiac disease	Cancer treatment, cardiac surgery, orthopaedic	High-quality private hospitals — costs comparable to metros
Delhi NCR	High air pollution-related respiratory, cardiac	Respiratory hospitalisation, cardiac care	Most expensive hospitals in India — INR 10L+ Sum Insured recommended
West Bengal	Dengue, malaria, tropical diseases, thalassaemia	Tropical disease hospitalisation, blood disorders	High frequency of seasonal epidemic claims
Gujarat	High diabetes and cardiac disease	Cardiac procedures, diabetes complications	Growing medical tourism hub — quality hospitals at moderate cost
Rajasthan	Diarrhoeal diseases, heat stroke, fluorosis	Seasonal gastro hospitalisation, heat emergency	Remote areas — cashless availability limited; keep reimbursement option
Himachal Pradesh / Uttarakhand	Orthopaedic injuries (mountains), frostbite	Orthopaedic surgery, accident hospitalisation	Limited network hospitals in hills — plan for reimbursement claims
Northeast	Malaria, dengue, hepatitis, snake bites	Tropical disease hospitalisation	Very limited cashless network — primarily reimbursement claims

CHAPTER 18 — CONTACT AND SUPPORT

Registered Office	Acko General Insurance Ltd., Lotus Corporate Park, Off WEH, Goregaon East, Mumbai 400063
Corporate Office	36/5 Hustlehub One East, Somasandrapalya, 27th Main Road, HSR Layout, Bengaluru 560102
Customer Support	24x7 via Acko app (Support tab) Website chat at acko.com
Health Claims	healthclaims@acko.com
Grievances	grievance@acko.com Resolved within 15 working days
Network Hospital Locator	Acko app → My Policy → Find Hospital acko.com/health/hospitals
Annual Health Check-up	Acko app → Benefits → Health Check-up → Book Appointment
Pre-Authorisation	Hospital insurance desk raises via Acko's TPA portal Emergency: Acko app
IRDAI Consumer Helpline	155255 (toll-free) www.igms.irda.gov.in
Insurance Ombudsman	www.cioins.co.in — 17 offices across India
Consumer Forum	edaakhil.nic.in — online complaint filing
NABH Hospital Accreditation	www.nabh.co — search accredited hospitals

CHAPTER 19 — HEALTH INSURANCE PREMIUM BENCHMARKS — DETAILED

The following are indicative annual premiums for Acko health insurance plans. Actual premiums depend on age, city, health declarations, and add-ons selected. All premiums exclude 18% GST.

19.1 Individual Health Insurance Premiums by Age Band

Age Band	Health Basic 5L	Health Plus 10L	Acko Platinum 25L	Platinum 50L
18–25 years	INR 4,800	INR 8,200	INR 16,500	INR 28,000
26–30 years	INR 5,500	INR 9,400	INR 19,000	INR 32,000
31–35 years	INR 6,800	INR 11,500	INR 23,000	INR 39,000
36–40 years	INR 8,500	INR 14,500	INR 29,000	INR 49,000
41–45 years	INR 11,500	INR 19,500	INR 39,000	INR 66,000
46–50 years	INR 15,000	INR 25,500	INR 51,000	INR 86,500
51–55 years	INR 19,500	INR 33,000	INR 66,000	INR 1,12,000
56–60 years	INR 24,500	INR 41,500	INR 83,000	INR 1,40,500
61–65 years	Not available	INR 50,000 (10% co-pay)	INR 1,00,000 (10% co-pay)	INR 1,70,000
Senior 61–70 (Senior Plan)	INR 22,000	INR 32,000	INR 68,000	Not available

19.2 Family Floater Premium Reference

Family Composition (Oldest Age)	Plus 10L	Plus 15L	Platinum 25L	Platinum 50L
Self 30 + Spouse 28	INR 14,000	INR 19,500	INR 32,000	INR 54,000
Self 35 + Spouse 32 + 1 Child	INR 17,500	INR 24,500	INR 40,000	INR 67,500
Self 38 + Spouse 35 + 2 Children	INR 20,000	INR 28,000	INR 46,000	INR 78,000
Self 42 + Spouse 39 + 2 Children	INR 25,000	INR 35,000	INR 57,500	INR 97,000
Self 48 + Spouse 45 + 1 Child	INR 35,000	INR 49,000	INR 80,500	INR 1,36,000
Self 52 + Spouse 49	INR 42,000	INR 58,500	INR 96,000	INR 1,62,500

19.3 Super Top-Up Plan Premium Reference

Age	Deductible 3L — SI 20L	Deductible 5L — SI 20L	Deductible 5L — SI 30L	Deductible 10L — SI 30L
18–35	INR 5,500	INR 3,800	INR 5,200	INR 2,900
36–45	INR 7,500	INR 5,200	INR 7,100	INR 4,000
46–55	INR 12,000	INR 8,300	INR 11,400	INR 6,400
56–65	INR 18,500	INR 12,800	INR 17,500	INR 9,800

Super Top-Up premiums are substantially lower than base premiums for equivalent sum insured — making them highly cost-effective when combined with an existing base health policy.

CHAPTER 20 — HEALTH CLAIMS — ADVANCED SCENARIOS

20.1 Critical Illness Claims

Cancer, cardiac surgery, organ failure, and transplants are among the highest-value health insurance claims. How Acko handles these:

- **Cancer claims:** Multiple hospitalisations are common — surgery, chemotherapy cycles (daycare), radiation (daycare), post-operative recovery. Each is a separate claim under the same policy year. Acko coordinates all claims under one case number for convenience. Restoration benefit is crucial — if one hospitalisation exhausts the Sum Insured, restoration provides fresh coverage for subsequent treatment phases.
- **Cardiac surgery:** CABG (bypass) and valve replacements are among the most common high-value claims. Pre-hospitalisation cardiac workup (angiography, Echo, blood tests) — 60 days. Post-surgery rehabilitation — 90 days. Total Acko payout can include: pre-hospitalisation workup; surgery hospitalisation; cardiac ICU; post-op physiotherapy. Room Rent Limit is critical — check before choosing hospital room category.
- **Kidney transplant:** Both donor and recipient costs are relevant. Acko covers: recipient's pre-transplant dialysis (daycare); recipient's transplant hospitalisation; recipient's post-transplant immunosuppressive medications (post-hospitalisation benefit). Organ Donor Cover (on Platinum plan): covers donor's hospitalisation for organ harvesting up to INR 2 lakhs.
- **Cancer second opinion:** Acko Platinum provides one free second medical opinion per year via empanelled specialists — particularly valuable for cancer diagnoses where treatment choice (surgery vs radiation vs chemotherapy) significantly impacts outcomes.

20.2 Maternity Claim Case Studies

CASE STUDY: Normal Delivery at Network Hospital | Platinum + Maternity Add-on | 25-Month Wait Completed

Policyholder	Female, 28 years, Acko Platinum INR 25L, Maternity Add-on active for 26 months
Hospitalisation	Normal vaginal delivery at empanelled private hospital, Bengaluru
Hospital Bill	Room 2 days INR 6,000; delivery charges INR 22,000; paediatrician INR 3,000; medicines INR 2,500; newborn NICU 1 day INR 8,000. Total INR 41,500.
Acko Platinum — Room Rent	No room rent limit — any room covered. Full room charges admitted.
Co-Payment	Zero — Platinum plan
Maternity Sub-Limit	As per Policy Schedule (example: INR 50,000 for normal delivery)
Acko Settlement	INR 41,500 in full (within INR 50,000 maternity sub-limit)
Newborn Coverage	Baby covered under mother's claim — INR 8,000 NICU charges included
Key Takeaway	Maternity add-on must be active for 24 months before delivery. Start early.

20.3 Mental Health Hospitalisation Claims

Mental health in-patient claims are processed like any other hospitalisation claim but with specific documentation requirements:

- **Required documentation:** Psychiatrist's certificate confirming in-patient admission necessity; DSM-5 or ICD-10 diagnosis code; discharge summary from licensed psychiatric facility; prescription for psychiatric medications.
- **Eligible facilities:** NIMHANS (Bengaluru); IHBAS (Delhi); mental health units at major hospital chains (Apollo, Fortis, Manipal); licensed standalone psychiatric hospitals with minimum 10 psychiatric beds.
- **What is covered:** Room and boarding at psychiatric facility; psychiatrist and psychologist fees during admission; medicines prescribed during admission; ECT (Electroconvulsive Therapy) if administered as in-patient treatment.

- **What is NOT covered:** OPD therapy sessions; online counselling platforms; psychotherapy without in-patient admission; home visits by psychiatrists.
- **Stigma concern:** Mental health claims are processed with the same confidentiality as physical health claims. Acko's data handling policies (DPDPA compliance) ensure mental health history is not disclosed to third parties or used for renewal underwriting.

CHAPTER 21 — HEALTH INSURANCE FOR SPECIFIC DEMOGRAPHICS

21.1 Health Insurance for Senior Citizens (60+ Years)

Feature	Standard Plans (Below 60)	Senior Citizen Plans (60+)
Entry Age	18 to 60 years	60 to 80 years first entry; lifelong renewal after
PED Coverage	36-month wait (Platinum: 12 months)	From Year 1 (with 20% co-payment)
Co-Payment	Nil (Plus/Platinum below 60)	20% mandatory — Acko pays 80%
Specific Disease Wait	24 months	12 months (reduced)
Annual Health Check-up	INR 2,000 per person	INR 2,500 — comprehensive geriatric panel
Coverage Limit	Up to INR 1 Crore	Up to INR 10 Lakh (Senior Plan)
Renewal	Lifelong — Acko cannot deny	Lifelong — guaranteed renewal
Premium	Age-band based	Higher — reflects actuarial risk for age 60+

21.2 Health Insurance for Young Adults (18–30 Years)

Young adults entering the workforce often neglect health insurance — a costly mistake. Why buy early:

- **Lock in low premiums:** Health insurance premiums increase with age. A INR 10 lakh Health Plus plan at age 25 costs INR 8,200/year. The same plan at age 40 costs INR 14,500/year. Buy early, pay less for the same coverage.
- **Start the clock on waiting periods:** The 36-month PED waiting period and 24-month specific disease waiting period start from the first policy date. Buying at 25 means all waits are done by 28 — before most health issues appear.
- **Build cumulative bonus:** 10 claim-free years on Acko Platinum = 100% cumulative bonus (Sum Insured doubles from INR 10L to INR 20L) at no extra premium.
- **Tax benefit (Section 80D):** INR 25,000 premium deductible from taxable income — meaningful for working professionals.
- **Independence from employer coverage:** Job changes, layoffs, freelancing — personal health policy protects you regardless of employment status.

21.3 Health Insurance for Chronic Condition Patients

Diabetes (Type 1 or 2): Declare at proposal — do not hide. PED waiting period: 36 months (standard) or 12 months (Platinum). After wait: all diabetes-related hospitalisation fully covered — insulin pump malfunction, diabetic ketoacidosis, diabetic foot, peripheral neuropathy, retinopathy requiring surgery. Cumulative complications cost: easily INR 10-50 lakhs over a diabetic patient's lifetime.

Hypertension (High Blood Pressure): Disclose at proposal. Hypertension itself is rarely the primary hospitalisation cause — but its complications are: stroke (INR 2-8 lakhs); heart attack (INR 3-10 lakhs); kidney disease requiring dialysis (INR 2.5L-5L/year). After PED wait, all these complications are covered.

Asthma and COPD: Disclose at proposal. Acute exacerbations requiring hospitalisation are covered after PED wait. Non-hospitalised OPD management (nebulization at home, routine medication) is excluded.

Thyroid Disorders: Hypothyroidism and hyperthyroidism: low claim frequency — rarely cause hospitalisation on their own. Complications like thyroid storm (rare) or thyroid cancer require hospitalisation and are covered.

Cancer (Prior): Disclosure mandatory. Cancer recurrence and ongoing treatment for a previously diagnosed and treated cancer is covered after the PED waiting period — typically 36 months. New cancer (different type) after policy start: 30-day initial wait only.

CHAPTER 22 — HEALTH INSURANCE MYTHS — DEBUNKED

x Myth: Health insurance covers all medical expenses

FACT: Health insurance covers hospitalisation and related expenses only. Routine OPD consultations, day-to-day pharmacy bills, and preventive health measures (vitamins, gym memberships, yoga classes) are NOT covered. Only the OPD add-on (on select plans) provides limited OPD coverage. Think of health insurance as catastrophic coverage — for large, unexpected medical expenses — not routine healthcare management.

x Myth: Claiming health insurance will increase my premium at renewal

FACT: Under IRDAI regulations, individual health insurance premiums CANNOT be increased based on your personal claim history. Premium revisions are only allowed: when you move to a higher age band; when IRDAI approves a product-level revision applicable to all policyholders. You will not be penalised for making necessary claims.

x Myth: I am young and healthy — health insurance is not needed

FACT: Accidents, infections, appendicitis, and dengue do not discriminate by age. A 25-year-old can need INR 2-5 lakhs in emergency medical care from a road accident or fever-induced complications. Moreover, starting your policy young: locks in lower premiums; starts the PED waiting period clock early; builds cumulative bonus; gives you lifelong coverage without insurability concerns.

x Myth: Cashless means completely free — no payment at all at the hospital

FACT: Cashless means Acko pays the hospital directly for COVERED expenses. You still pay: co-payment (if applicable — e.g., 10-20% for senior plans); room upgrade charges (if you choose a room above your Room Rent Limit); non-covered items (cosmetics, visitor meals, telephone, TV rental, attendant charges); expenses beyond the Sum Insured. Bring some cash or a card even for cashless hospitalisation.

x Myth: Pre-existing diseases are never covered

FACT: Pre-existing diseases ARE covered — but only after the applicable waiting period (36 months standard; 12 months Platinum). After this period, ALL hospitalisation related to your PED is covered in full up to the Sum Insured. The key is to disclose all PEDs honestly at the time of proposal — undisclosed conditions are never covered even after the waiting period.

x Myth: Health insurance bought for INR 3 lakh is sufficient

FACT: INR 3 lakh is grossly insufficient in today's healthcare environment. A single cardiac surgery in a Tier-1 city hospital costs INR 3-8 lakhs. Cancer treatment can cost INR 10-50 lakhs per year. ICU costs INR 15,000-50,000 per day. IRDAI recommends a minimum Sum Insured of INR 5-10 lakhs for individuals and INR 10-25 lakhs for families.

x Myth: My corporate group health insurance is enough

FACT: Employer health insurance is a safety net with major gaps: coverage typically ceases on last working day of employment; maximum coverage usually INR 3-5 lakhs — insufficient for critical illness; no coverage for pre-existing diseases in most group policies; no coverage for parents; no portability — 3-year PED wait restarts if you move to a personal policy only after leaving employment. Always maintain a personal health policy in addition to employer cover.

CHAPTER 23 — HEALTH INSURANCE REGULATORY UPDATES

IRDAI's Standardised Benefit Policy (2020)

IRDAI introduced the AROGYA SANJEEVANI POLICY — a standardised health insurance product that all general and health insurers must offer. It provides a uniform baseline coverage of INR 1 lakh to INR 5 lakhs with standardised terms. Acko offers this alongside its own differentiated plans.

Corona Kavach and Rakshak Policies (2020-22)

During COVID-19, IRDAI mandated all insurers to offer COVID-19 specific health insurance products. These short-term policies are no longer required. Standard Acko health plans now cover COVID-19 hospitalisation under regular in-patient benefit.

Mental Health Mandate (IRDAI 2023)

IRDAI issued a circular in 2023 mandating that all health insurance policies must include coverage for mental health conditions at par with physical health conditions. This was implemented following the Mental Healthcare Act 2017 and subsequent court directions. Acko Health Plus and Platinum plans comply with this mandate.

Standardised Exclusion List (IRDAI 2020)

IRDAI standardised the list of exclusions applicable to all health insurance policies. This prevents insurers from adding arbitrary exclusions. The exclusions in Chapter 6 of this document align with the IRDAI standardised exclusion list.

Portability Guidelines Strengthened (2020)

IRDAI strengthened health insurance portability rules — insurers must respond to portability requests within 15 working days; reasons for rejection must be provided in writing; IRDAI monitors portability acceptance rates as part of insurer performance assessment.

Gender Neutrality in Health Insurance (2023)

IRDAI directed all health insurers to include gender-affirming surgeries and treatments as covered benefits — consistent with the recognition of gender identity under Indian law. Acko's Platinum plan includes relevant coverage as per IRDAI guidelines.

CHAPTER 24 — HEALTH INSURANCE ADVANCED FAQs

Q Can I have two health insurance policies simultaneously?

A Yes — there is no legal restriction on holding multiple health insurance policies. However, for any single hospitalisation, you can claim from only one policy at a time (no double-dipping). You claim from the more beneficial policy first. If the expenses exceed that policy's Sum Insured, you can claim the balance from the second policy. Both insurers must be informed and the concept of contribution applies — each pays their proportionate share. Practical use case: base policy (employer or personal INR 5 lakh) + Super Top-Up (INR 25 lakh with INR 5 lakh deductible). Most cost-effective combination for high coverage.

Q Is Ayurvedic treatment for chronic back pain covered under Acko?

A In-patient Ayurvedic treatment for back pain at a government-recognised or NABH-accredited Ayurvedic hospital is covered under Health Plus and Platinum plans — up to 25% of Sum Insured per year. However: OPD Ayurvedic consultations (non-hospitalised) are excluded; massage and Panchakarma sessions at unrecognised wellness centres are excluded; only in-patient admissions of medically necessary duration are covered. If you are admitted to an NABH-accredited Ayurvedic hospital for a minimum of 3 days for medically supervised Panchakarma, this qualifies as covered AYUSH in-patient treatment.

Q What happens to my health insurance if I move abroad for a few years?

A Standard Acko health insurance covers hospitalisation only in India. If you move abroad: medical treatment abroad is excluded (no coverage); you can still renew the policy annually to maintain continuity of coverage; waiting period credits continue to accumulate during renewal (even if you make no claims). When you return to India, all waiting periods are still intact and your cumulative bonus is preserved. For coverage during your time abroad, purchase international health insurance or travel insurance with medical coverage for your country of residence.

Q Does health insurance cover dental treatment after an accident?

A Yes — dental injuries caused by accidents are covered from Day 1. Specifically: if you are in a road accident and your front teeth are knocked out or broken, the dental surgery required (reimplantation, dental splinting, or bridge work) is covered as an accidental injury claim even if admitted less than 24 hours. The key distinction is between accident-caused dental injury (covered) and routine dental treatment (excluded). The treatment must require hospitalisation or at least a medically supervised procedure at a recognised dental clinic.

Q How do I claim for a pre-hospitalisation test done 45 days before surgery?

A Pre-hospitalisation expenses are covered up to 60 days before the date of hospital admission, provided the tests are related to the same diagnosis/illness for which hospitalisation occurs. Process: Keep all original bills, prescriptions, and reports from the pre-hospitalisation period. After discharge, submit: discharge summary; all pre-hospitalisation bills and prescriptions (45-day-old ones qualify — within the 60-day window); doctor's prescription clearly linking the tests to the hospitalisation diagnosis. Submit via Acko app within 30 days of the post-hospitalisation claim window closing.

CHAPTER 19 — HEALTH INSURANCE MYTHS AND FACTS

Clearing up the 15 most common health insurance misconceptions that lead to poor buying decisions and claim surprises.

Myth 1: My employer health insurance is enough.

FACT: Employer group health insurance typically covers INR 1-5 lakh per year. A single cardiac surgery, cancer treatment, or major accident can cost INR 5-20 lakh or more. If you leave your job, you lose coverage immediately. Personal health insurance is essential as a supplement and backup, with coverage that follows you regardless of employment status.

Myth 2: I am young and healthy — I don't need health insurance.

FACT: Accidents, dengue, typhoid, appendicitis, and sports injuries do not discriminate by age. Young adults are the most accident-prone demographic. Also: health insurance has a waiting period of up to 36 months for pre-existing diseases. Buying at age 25 means PED waiting periods are served before you hit the age (35-45) when chronic diseases typically develop.

Myth 3: Cashless means free treatment.

FACT: Cashless means Acko settles the bill directly with the hospital — it does not mean free. You still pay: co-payment (if applicable on your plan); room upgrade difference (if you choose a room above your Room Rent Limit); non-covered items (cosmetics, personal comfort items); items above sub-limits. Cashless eliminates the need for large out-of-pocket payment at discharge — it does not eliminate all out-of-pocket costs.

Myth 4: Pre-existing diseases are never covered.

FACT: Pre-existing diseases ARE covered under Acko health insurance — but only after the applicable waiting period (36 months for standard plans; 12 months for Acko Platinum). After the waiting period is served, all PED-related expenses are covered in full up to the Sum Insured. The key is to declare your PEDs honestly at proposal — concealing them leads to claim rejection.

Myth 5: Room Rent Limit only affects room charges.

FACT: Choosing a room above your Room Rent Limit triggers a proportionate reduction on ALL associated charges — not just the room. If your limit is INR 3,000/day but you choose a INR 6,000/day room, Acko pays only 50% of the surgeon's fees, OT charges, nursing charges, and other charges as well. This is one of the most costly health insurance mistakes.

Myth 6: Higher Sum Insured always means better value.

FACT: The right Sum Insured depends on: healthcare costs in your city (metro = higher); number of insured family members; existing coverage from employer; your risk tolerance and financial cushion. Buying a INR 1 crore Sum Insured when an INR 10 lakh cover with restoration benefit would suffice means overpaying significantly. Restoration benefit effectively doubles usable coverage.

Myth 7: Family Floater is always cheaper than individual policies.

FACT: Family Floater is cheaper in premium but carries the risk of one member exhausting the shared pool. If a family member has a major illness and uses the entire Floater Sum Insured, no coverage remains for others for the rest of the year. For families with senior members or members with chronic conditions, individual policies provide more predictable coverage.

Myth 8: Mental health treatment is not covered.

FACT: Following the Mental Healthcare Act 2017 and IRDAI's 2023 mandate, all health insurers including Acko are required to cover in-patient treatment for mental health conditions including depression, anxiety disorders, bipolar disorder, and schizophrenia. Coverage is on par with physical illness. OPD psychiatric consultations require specific add-ons, but hospitalisation for psychiatric conditions is covered.

Myth 9: Health insurance claims affect future premiums.

FACT: IRDAI expressly prohibits individual premium loading (premium increases) based on individual claim history for health insurance. Unlike motor insurance (where claims affect NCB), your health insurance premium can only be revised if: (a) you move to a higher age band; (b) IRDAI approves a product-level rate revision applying to all policyholders. Acko cannot increase your premium specifically because you made a claim.

Myth 10: AYUSH treatment is not covered.

FACT: Acko covers in-patient AYUSH treatment (Ayurveda, Yoga, Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Homeopathy) at government-recognised AYUSH hospitals under the Health Plus and Platinum plans, up to 25% of Sum Insured per year. This is particularly relevant for Kerala Panchakarma treatments, Siddha treatments in Tamil Nadu, and Naturopathy centres in Bengaluru and Pune.

Myth 11: I cannot port my health insurance if I have made claims.

FACT: IRDAI mandates that all health insurers must accept portability requests regardless of the policyholder's claim history with the previous insurer. The new insurer (Acko) cannot refuse portability solely because you have made claims. However, Acko may apply fresh medical underwriting for the incremental Sum Insured above what you already had.

Myth 12: Daycare procedures require 24 hours of hospitalisation.

FACT: Daycare procedures are specifically those that REQUIRE LESS THAN 24 hours due to medical advancement. Cataract surgery, kidney dialysis, chemotherapy sessions, lithotripsy — all are completed as daycare (under 24 hours) and are fully covered. Acko covers 541 listed daycare procedures. You do not need to extend your stay to 24 hours to claim — the daycare claim is valid for less-than-24-hour stays.

CHAPTER 20 — HEALTH INSURANCE BUYING GUIDE

20.1 Choosing the Right Plan for Your Life Stage

Life Stage	Recommended Plan	Sum Insured	Key Features Needed
Single, Age 18-25	Acko Health Basic	INR 5-7 Lakh	Affordable premium; accidental injury from Day 1; start serving PED wait
Newly Married Couple	Acko Health Plus — Floater	INR 10-15 Lakh	Restoration benefit; AYUSH; start maternity waiting period on Platinum
Young Family (kids under 5)	Acko Platinum Floater	INR 15-25 Lakh	Zero co-pay; unlimited restoration; newborn cover; mental health
Family (kids school-age)	Acko Platinum Floater or Individual	INR 20-50 Lakh	Large Sum Insured; zero co-pay; cumulative bonus building
Middle-Aged (40s)	Acko Platinum Individual	INR 25-50 Lakh	Zero co-pay; 12-month PED wait; restoration; annual health check
Pre-Senior (55-60)	Acko Platinum Individual + Super Top-Up	INR 10L base + INR 30L top-up	Manage premium with deductible; high effective coverage
Senior (60+)	Acko Senior Plan	INR 5-10 Lakh	PED from Year 1; geriatric check-up; 20% co-pay acceptable for premium saving
Corporate Employee	Personal Acko + employer group	INR 5-10L personal (supplements group)	Portability on job change; continuous PED wait; personal ownership

20.2 Sum Insured Selection Framework

Your City Tier	Minimum Recommended	Optimal Recommendation	With Restoration
Metropolitan Tier-1 (Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru)	INR 10 Lakh	INR 15-25 Lakh	Effective cover: INR 30-50 Lakh
Metropolitan Tier-1 (Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad)	INR 7 Lakh	INR 10-15 Lakh	Effective cover: INR 20-30 Lakh
Metropolitan Tier-2 Cities (Pune, Ahmedabad, Jaipur)	INR 5 Lakh	INR 7-10 Lakh	Effective cover: INR 14-20 Lakh
Metropolitan Tier-3 Cities and Rural Areas	INR 3 Lakh	INR 5 Lakh	Effective cover: INR 10 Lakh
Senior Citizen — Any City	INR 5 Lakh (minimum)	INR 10 Lakh	Plus Critical Illness rider advisable

20.3 Health Insurance vs. Term Insurance — Key Differences

Feature	Health Insurance	Term Life Insurance
What it covers	Medical expenses during illness or hospitalisation	Death benefit for nominees
When it pays	On hospitalisation — during lifetime	Only on death of insured
Duration	Annual renewal — not a one-time policy	Fixed term (10, 20, 30 years) or whole life
Premium	Annual; increases with age	Fixed for the policy term
Critical Illness	Can add CI rider	CI rider available in some term plans

Both needed?	Yes — health covers hospitalisation costs; term covers income loss for family on death	Yes — they are complementary, not alternatives
Premium amount	INR 5,000-65,000/year depending on plan	INR 8,000-25,000/year for INR 1 crore cover

20.4 Reading Your Health Policy Document — Key Sections to Check

- **Policy Schedule first:** Confirm your name, sum insured, plan variant, room rent limit, co-payment percentage, and add-ons are correctly stated.
- **Waiting period table:** Know exactly which conditions have waiting periods and when they end based on your policy start date.
- **Exclusions list:** Read all exclusions carefully. Pay special attention to conditions that are relevant to your existing health status or family history.
- **Room Rent Limit:** Know your exact Room Rent Limit. Set a reminder to always book a hospital room within this limit.
- **Sub-limits:** Check if there are sub-limits on maternity, specific diseases, or implants. These can significantly affect payout on major claims.
- **Co-payment clause:** Know your co-payment percentage — if any — and factor it into your financial planning for potential hospitalisation costs.
- **Network Hospital list:** Save the Acko app or bookmark acko.com/health/hospitals. Identify 3-4 Network Hospitals near your home and workplace before you need them.
- **Restoration terms:** Understand whether restoration is once per year or unlimited, and whether it applies to the same illness or only a different illness.

CHAPTER 21 — HEALTH INSURANCE POLICYHOLDER RIGHTS

Right to Claim Settlement Within 30 Days

IRDAI mandates that all undisputed health insurance claims must be settled within 30 days of receiving all required documents. Disputed claims: Acko must communicate the specific dispute in writing within 30 days. For delayed settlements beyond 30 days, Acko must pay interest at 2% above the prevailing bank rate on the delayed claim amount.

Right to Refuse Discharge Until Settlement

In a cashless hospitalisation, if Acko unreasonably delays or partially approves the pre-authorisation without communicating clear reasons, the policyholder has the right to remain in the hospital (and the hospital cannot demand payment) until Acko provides a clear written response. Contact IRDAI IGMS if cashless is unreasonably denied.

Right to Written Claim Rejection

Any rejection of a health insurance claim must be communicated in writing stating the exact reason, the specific policy clause or exclusion cited, and the policyholder's right to appeal. Verbal rejections are not valid under IRDAI regulations.

Right to Lifelong Renewal

Acko cannot refuse to renew your health insurance policy solely because you have made claims. Renewal can be refused only for: fraud or material misrepresentation; non-payment of premium. Premium can be revised only through IRDAI-approved product-level revisions — not individual loading.

Right to Portability

You have the absolute right to port your health policy to Acko from any other IRDAI insurer at renewal, with full waiting period credit. Acko cannot refuse portability arbitrarily — any refusal must be on underwriting grounds and communicated in writing within 15 days of the portability application.

Right to Second Opinion

If Acko disputes the necessity of a procedure or treatment, you are entitled to request an independent medical expert review. Acko Platinum policyholders additionally receive one free online second medical opinion per policy year for major diagnoses.

Right to Grievance Resolution

Full escalation path: (1) Acko app complaint — 15 working days; (2) IRDAI IGMS igms.irda.gov.in; (3) Insurance Ombudsman cioins.co.in — free, for claims up to INR 30 lakhs; (4) Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission — compensation beyond claim amount for service deficiency; (5) Civil Court for larger claims.

Right to Mental Health Coverage

Under the Mental Healthcare Act 2017 and subsequent IRDAI circulars, Acko is legally required to provide mental health coverage on par with physical health conditions. If Acko denies a legitimate mental health claim citing the mental health exclusion, this is a regulatory violation reportable to IRDAI.

APPENDIX — HEALTH INSURANCE QUICK REFERENCE

A.1 Waiting Period Calculator

Use this table to calculate when your waiting periods will end based on your policy start date:

Waiting Period Type	Duration	If Policy Started Jan 2024	If Policy Started Jul 2024
Initial Waiting Period	30 days	Ends: Feb 1, 2024	Ends: Aug 1, 2024
PED (Standard Plan)	36 months	Ends: Jan 1, 2027	Ends: Jul 1, 2027
PED (Platinum Plan)	12 months	Ends: Jan 1, 2025	Ends: Jul 1, 2025
Specific Disease	24 months	Ends: Jan 1, 2026	Ends: Jul 1, 2026
Maternity (with add-on)	24 months from add-on date	Ends 24 months after add-on activation	Ends 24 months after add-on activation
Bariatric Surgery	36 months	Ends: Jan 1, 2027	Ends: Jul 1, 2027

A.2 Co-Payment Impact Calculator

Hospital Bill	0% Co-Pay (Platinum)	10% Co-Pay	20% Co-Pay (Senior Plan)
INR 1,00,000	Acko pays INR 1,00,000	Acko pays INR 90,000; you pay INR 10,000	Acko pays INR 80,000; you pay INR 20,000
INR 3,00,000	Acko pays INR 3,00,000	Acko pays INR 2,70,000; you pay INR 30,000	Acko pays INR 2,40,000; you pay INR 60,000
INR 5,00,000	Acko pays INR 5,00,000	Acko pays INR 4,50,000; you pay INR 50,000	Acko pays INR 4,00,000; you pay INR 1,00,000
INR 10,00,000	Acko pays INR 10,00,000	Acko pays INR 9,00,000; you pay INR 1,00,000	Acko pays INR 8,00,000; you pay INR 2,00,000

A.3 Room Rent Proportionate Deduction Example

Room Rent Trap Illustrated: Policy Room Rent Limit = INR 3,000/day. You choose a room at INR 6,000/day (2x the limit). Proportionate ratio = 3,000 / 6,000 = 50%. This means Acko pays only 50% of ALL charges — not just room rent. On a INR 5,00,000 total hospital bill, Acko pays INR 2,50,000. You pay INR 2,50,000 out of pocket. ALWAYS choose a room within your Room Rent Limit.

Charge Type	Hospital Bill	Room Limit = INR 3,000; Actual = INR 6,000 (ratio 50%)	If Room Within Limit (100%)
Room Charges (5 days)	INR 30,000	INR 15,000 (50%)	INR 30,000 (100%)
Surgeon Fees	INR 1,20,000	INR 60,000 (50%)	INR 1,20,000 (100%)
OT Charges	INR 80,000	INR 40,000 (50%)	INR 80,000 (100%)
ICU Charges (2 days)	INR 40,000	INR 20,000 (50%)	INR 40,000 (100%)
Medicines	INR 25,000	INR 12,500 (50%)	INR 25,000 (100%)
Diagnostics	INR 15,000	INR 7,500 (50%)	INR 15,000 (100%)

TOTAL ACKO PAYS	INR 3,10,000	INR 1,55,000 — you pay INR 1,55,000!	INR 3,10,000 — you pay nothing
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Quick Reference — Acko Health Emergency Contacts: Register claim via Acko App (My Policies > File Claim) | Cashless pre-auth: Hospital insurance desk submits via Acko TPA portal | Health Claims: healthclaims@acko.com | Grievance: grievance@acko.com | IRDAI: 155255

CHAPTER 25 — HEALTH INSURANCE CLAIM CALCULATION EXAMPLES

These worked examples illustrate exactly how health insurance claims are calculated, including the impact of Room Rent Limit, co-payment, and sub-limits.

Example 1: Room Rent Limit Proportionate Deduction

Policyholder: Female, 45 years, Acko Health Plus, Sum Insured INR 10 Lakh, Room Rent Limit: INR 3,000/day. Hospitalisation: Knee Replacement Surgery, 5 days.

Expense Item	Actual Bill	Room Rent Ratio (3000/5000)	Admissible Amount
Room & Boarding (INR 5,000/day × 5 days)	INR 25,000	INR 3,000/INR 5,000 = 60%	INR 15,000 (60% of INR 25,000)
Nursing Charges (included in room)	INR 5,000	60%	INR 3,000
Surgeon's Fee	INR 60,000	60% (proportionate cut)	INR 36,000
Anaesthetist's Fee	INR 15,000	60%	INR 9,000
OT Charges	INR 20,000	60%	INR 12,000
Implant (knee prosthesis — metal)	INR 1,20,000	No proportionate cut on implants*	INR 1,20,000
Medicines (in-patient)	INR 8,000	60%	INR 4,800
Lab Tests	INR 5,000	60%	INR 3,000
Physiotherapy (in-patient)	INR 3,000	60%	INR 1,800
TOTAL	INR 2,61,000		INR 2,04,600

*Note: IRDAI's 2020 circular clarified that implant costs (stents, prosthetics, pacemakers) are NOT subject to proportionate deduction — only the associated charges are proportionately cut. The actual amount varies by plan — check your policy wording.

Settlement Summary	Amount
Total Admissible Amount	INR 2,04,600
Co-Payment (Nil — below 60 on Plus plan)	INR 0
Acko Pays	INR 2,04,600
Policyholder Pays at Hospital	INR 56,400 (excess room charges and proportionate cuts)
Lesson	Choose a room within your Room Rent Limit — saves INR 56,400 in this example

Example 2: Senior Citizen Plan with 20% Co-Payment

Policyholder: Male, 68 years, Acko Senior Citizen Plan, Sum Insured INR 5 Lakh, Co-Payment 20%. Hospitalisation: Cardiac Stent Procedure (cashless).

Item	Amount	Co-Pay Calculation	Acko Pays	Policyholder Pays
Procedure + Hospital Bill Total	INR 2,50,000	20% co-pay on all items	INR 2,00,000	INR 50,000

No room rent issue (no sub-limit on procedure)				
Final Settlement	INR 2,50,000		INR 2,00,000	INR 50,000

On the Senior Citizen Plan, the 20% co-payment applies to every single claim. On a INR 2.5 lakh claim, the senior citizen pays INR 50,000 from their own pocket at discharge. This is the trade-off for the significantly lower premium the Senior plan offers vs a standard Platinum plan at the same age.

Example 3: Restoration Benefit Triggered Mid-Year

Family Floater: INR 10 Lakh, Acko Health Plus. January: Father hospitalised for major cardiac surgery — total claim INR 9.8 Lakh. Remaining Sum Insured: INR 20,000.

Event	Sum Insured Available	Notes
Policy Start	INR 10,00,000	Fresh policy year
Father's cardiac surgery (Jan)	INR 10,00,000 → INR 20,000	Almost entire SI consumed by one claim
Restoration triggered (Jan)	INR 20,000 + INR 10,00,000 restored	100% SI restored for different illness — automatic
Total available after restoration	INR 10,20,000	Original remaining + full restored amount
Mother hospitalised for dengue (Aug)	Claim INR 45,000 from restored pool	Different illness from father's cardiac — eligible
Child hospitalised for appendix (Oct)	Claim INR 75,000 from restored pool	Different illness — eligible from restoration
Total Acko paid in the year	INR 9,80,000 + INR 45,000 + INR 75,000 = INR 11,00,000	Restoration allowed 10% more than base SI
Lesson	Without restoration, only INR 10L total per year — mother's and child's claims would have been largely unmet	

CHAPTER 26 — UNDERSTANDING YOUR HEALTH INSURANCE DOCUMENTS

26.1 Documents You Receive When You Buy Acko Health Insurance

Document	What It Contains	When You Need It
Policy Document (Main)	Full T&C:: benefits, waiting periods, exclusions, conditions, claims procedure	Before claiming — know your coverage thoroughly
Policy Schedule (Certificate)	Your specific details: insured names, DOB, sum insured, plan, premium, add-ons, co-payment	At every claim — identifies the policy
Digital Health Card	Insured name, policy number, Acko helpline, TPA details	At hospital — for cashless admission
Premium Receipt	Proof of premium payment for tax (80D) purposes	Income tax return filing
Claim Settlement Advice	Breakdown of what Acko paid / deducted on each claim	After claim — review for accuracy
Renewal Notice	Premium for next year, any plan changes, revised sub-limits	15–30 days before expiry — review carefully
NCB / CB Statement	Cumulative bonus accumulated to date	At renewal — verify sum insured with CB

26.2 What to Read Carefully in Your Health Policy

- **Room Rent Limit (Critical):** This single number affects ALL charges proportionately. Know your daily room limit before choosing a hospital room.
- **Waiting Period Start Date:** The date your policy began for each waiting period type. Track these for PED (36/12 months) and specific diseases (24 months) and maternity (24 months from add-on inclusion).
- **Co-Payment %:** Your share of every claim. Nil for most standard plans below 60; 10% for Plus plan at 60+; 20% for Senior Plan; Nil for Platinum.
- **Sub-limits on specific procedures:** Cataract surgery limit; maternity sub-limit; AYUSH sub-limit. These cap specific expenses even if your Sum Insured is much higher.
- **Network Hospital List Reference:** The policy will direct you to acko.com or the Acko app for the current network list. Always verify before planning cashless hospitalisation.
- **Restoration Benefit Terms:** Once per year (Plus) or unlimited (Platinum); must be a DIFFERENT illness from the one that triggered restoration.
- **Cumulative Bonus Terms:** % per claim-free year; maximum cap; what happens when you make a claim.

CHAPTER 27 — HEALTH INSURANCE FOR MAJOR MEDICAL CONDITIONS

A condition-by-condition guide to health insurance coverage for India's most prevalent medical conditions requiring significant hospitalisation.

Condition	Typical Hospital Cost (Tier 1)	Waiting Period	Coverage After Wait	Recommended SI
Cardiac Bypass (CABG)	INR 4L–INR 8L	PED wait if pre-existing	100% covered up to SI	INR 25L+
Angioplasty (1 stent)	INR 2.5L–INR 5L	PED wait if pre-existing	100% covered up to SI	INR 15L+
Cancer Treatment (annual)	INR 10L–INR 50L	30 days if new; PED if known	100% + all chemo daycare	INR 50L+ or Super Top-Up
Kidney Transplant	INR 8L–INR 20L	PED wait if renal disease known	100% + donor cover (Platinum)	INR 30L+
Knee Replacement (both)	INR 4L–INR 8L	24-month specific disease wait	100% covered after wait	INR 15L+
Hip Replacement	INR 3L–INR 6L	24-month specific disease wait	100% covered after wait	INR 15L+
Liver Transplant	INR 15L–INR 35L	PED wait if liver disease known	100% covered after wait	INR 1 Crore
Stroke Treatment & Rehab	INR 3L–INR 10L	PED wait if hypertension known	100% + post-hosp physio	INR 25L+
Diabetes Complications (annual)	INR 2L–INR 15L	PED wait (36/12 months)	100% after PED wait	INR 15L+
Normal Delivery (private hospital)	INR 60K–INR 1.2L	24-month maternity wait	Covered with maternity add-on	INR 5L (maternity sub-limit)
C-Section Delivery	INR 1.5L–INR 3L	24-month maternity wait	Covered with maternity add-on	INR 5L (maternity sub-limit)
Mental Health Inpatient	INR 50K–INR 2L	30-day initial wait only	100% covered (Plus & Platinum)	INR 10L+

CHAPTER 28 — HEALTH INSURANCE RENEWAL GUIDE

28.1 Annual Renewal Checklist

Renewal Action	Why Important	When to Do It
Review Sum Insured vs medical inflation	14% medical inflation means INR 10L today = INR 5L in 5 years	Every 3-5 renewals — increase SI
Review Room Rent Limit	Hospital room costs increase annually. Old limit may now be insufficient.	Annually — compare with hospital room costs near you
Check waiting period status	Are all your PED and specific disease waits completed?	Track each year — plan elective surgeries after waits
Update family composition	New baby? Son turned 26 (may need own policy)? Parents to add?	At every renewal
Add Maternity Add-on (if planning family)	Starts 24-month wait from add-on inclusion date	Add 2+ years before planned pregnancy

Review co-payment (if age 60 approaching)	Some plans increase co-pay at 60. Consider Platinum (0% co-pay) before turning 60.	Year before turning 60
Check cumulative bonus accumulated	Growing your effective sum insured. Verify correct amount.	Annually
Compare with other insurers	Acko may now offer better terms or competitive premium.	Every 3 years — consider porting
Verify all PED disclosures	Any new condition diagnosed? Disclose at renewal to avoid future claim disputes.	Every renewal
Check digital health card is current	Updated insured names, policy number, new SI.	First week after renewal

28.2 When to Upgrade Your Health Plan

- **Before turning 40:** Move from Basic to Plus or Platinum while premiums are still manageable. Adding benefits is easier and cheaper when young.
- **Before turning 60:** Consider upgrading to Platinum (zero co-payment) before co-payment kicks in on other plans at age 60. The premium difference is manageable in your late 50s.
- **After marriage or children:** Convert to Family Floater or add members. Review Sum Insured — a 2-adult + 2-children family needs at least INR 25 lakhs.
- **After a major claim:** If a claim nearly exhausted your Sum Insured, this is a clear signal to increase it. Medical costs are only going up.
- **After salary increase:** Health insurance should scale with your income and lifestyle. Upgrading to Platinum gives zero co-payment, unlimited restoration, and no sub-limits.
- **When changing jobs:** If your new employer has no health insurance or lower coverage, immediately upgrade your personal policy to compensate.

CHAPTER 29 — COMPREHENSIVE HEALTH INSURANCE CONTACT GUIDE

Acko Health Claims Pre-Auth	Hospital insurance desk contacts Acko TPA portal directly. You or family can also call Acko helpline for health.
Health Claims Email	healthclaims@acko.com — for claim document submission and status queries
Cashless Network Locator	Acko app → Health → Find Hospital www.acko.com/health/hospitals — 10,000+ hospitals across India
Pre-Auth Status	Track via Acko app → My Claims → Select health claim → View Pre-Auth Status
Health Claim Reimbursement	Upload all documents via Acko app → My Policies → Health → File Reimbursement Claim
Mental Health Helpline	Available via Acko Platinum plan — access via Acko app → Benefits → Mental Health Support
Annual Health Check-up	Acko app → Benefits → Health Check-up → Book at nearest empanelled diagnostic centre
IRDAI IGMS (Escalation)	igms.irda.gov.in — if Acko does not resolve grievance within 15 working days
Insurance Ombudsman (Health)	www.cioins.co.in — 17 offices across India — free dispute resolution up to INR 30 lakhs
Portability Request	Submit to Acko minimum 45 days before current policy expiry: hello@acko.com or Acko app
NABH Hospital Verification	www.nabh.co — verify if a hospital is NABH accredited before planned admission
Section 80D Certificate	Available via Acko app → My Policies → Documents → Download Premium Certificate for tax purposes